ZCAS University

SMS1281: ACADEMIC WRITING/BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

Final examination

Date: 29th November, 2023

TIME: 08:30-11:30 HOURS

TIME ALLOWED: WRITING – THREE HOURS

READING – 5 MINUTES

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Section A: this question is **compulsory** and must be attempted.
2. Sections B: Answer **THREE (3)** questions from this section.
3. This examination paper carries a total of **100 marks.**
4. Candidates must **not turn this page** until the invigilator tells them to do so.

SECTION A: Question 1 is compulsory and must be attempted

Question 1

Case study

Briefing Meeting: Cyber Intrusion in the Organization

Meeting Date: December 18, 2023, Venue conference room 24

This case study probes into a critical cyber security meeting briefing that unfolded in the wake of a significant cyber intrusion into an organization's systems. The breach resulted in unauthorized access to internal systems, including sensitive customer data, financial records, and proprietary information, leading to financial losses and the potential for reputational damage. The key stakeholders in this briefing include the IT Security Director, HR Manager, IT Director, Legal Counsel, and the Chairperson, each playing a vital role in addressing the breach's impact and formulating a strategy for future cybersecurity measures.

Here is a verbatim briefing meeting

Chairperson: Good morning, everyone. The purpose of this meeting is to address the recent cyber intrusion into our organization's systems and discuss the steps we need to take to secure our data. As management of Chimpapila unit finance Bank, this meeting examines the damages incurred as a result of the intrusion, the formulation of clear guidelines for remote work to adapt to the operational disruption caused by the breach, and the plan for reporting the matter to law enforcement agencies for further investigations. As cyber threats continue to evolve, understanding how our organization should respond to breaches and adapt security measures is crucial for safeguarding sensitive data and maintaining the trust of customers and stakeholders. Let's explore the details of this critical cyber security meeting and the strategies employed to mitigate the situation.

IT Security Director: We recently detected a breach that compromised sensitive data. The breach originated from a phishing attack on one of our employees. We have taken immediate steps to contain the incident.

IT Director: We are working on enhancing our cybersecurity measures to prevent future incidents. This includes employee training on recognizing and avoiding phishing attacks and implementing multi-factor authentication.

Legal Counsel: We need to be transparent with our customers about this breach and the actions we're taking to protect their data. This aligns with our ethical communication guidelines.

Chairperson: Our IT security team will provide regular updates on the progress of our cybersecurity improvements, and we will conduct a post-mortem analysis to learn from this incident and prevent future cyber intrusions.

IT Security Director: To provide a more comprehensive understanding of the damages caused by this cyber intrusion, it's essential to note that the breach resulted in unauthorized access to our internal systems, including customer data, financial records, and proprietary information. This breach has already resulted in financial losses due to data theft and potential reputational damage.

HR Manager: In light of this situation, it's crucial that we establish clear guidelines for remote work. The disruption caused by the intrusion has led to an increased need for employees to work remotely. We need to ensure that our remote work practices are secure and aligned with our organization's policies.

IT Director: We'll be providing guidelines to all employees regarding remote work, emphasizing the importance of using secure, company-approved tools for communication and file sharing. Additionally, employees should always connect through our VPN to safeguard data during remote work.

Legal Counsel: In terms of reporting the matter to law enforcement agencies, we are actively working with external cybersecurity experts to gather evidence and determine the extent of the breach. Once we have a clearer picture, we will report the incident to the appropriate authorities for further investigation.

Chairperson: It is essential that we remain vigilant during this time and keep open lines of communication both internally and with our customers. The combined efforts of our IT security

team, legal department, and external experts will help us address the breach and minimize its impact. We will continue to provide updates as we progress through this situation

Required

A. Transcribe the minutes of the Cyber Intrusion in the Organization briefing meeting, including the source of the breach, immediate containment steps, and the long-term measures being taken to enhance cybersecurity. (30 marks)

B. Identify and explain five cyber security measures that the organisation can put in place to prevent an external intrusion. (10 marks)

(Total 40 marks)

SECTION B: Attempt any THREE questions in this section

Question 2

A. Discuss the reasons why the four sources below are regarded as reputable or credible for academic use, and allocate marks accordingly.

I. Journal articles (2 marks)
II. PhD theses (2 marks)
III. Textbooks (2 marks)
IV. Newspapers

B. Critically examine the significance of analytical and argumentative skills in the context of academic writing. Explore methods to enhance the strength of your arguments and improve the clarity of your writing for better reader comprehension.

Required:

Explain how you would use the following Boolean operators in your search and evaluate the likely outcome of each search.

(i) AND **(4 marks)**

(ii) OR **(4 marks)**

(iii) NOT **(4 marks)**

(Total: 20 marks)

Question 3

You are a recent graduate from ZACAS University who is applying for jobs and internships in your academic field. A few months ago, you decided to apply for an internship at ZCAS university and this has also taken longer to receive any response from the office of the registrar of the institution. As a former student who studied at the same institution, you were hopeful that your application for an internship was going to be considered. Based on this background, you decided to write a letter to ZCAS University to follow up on your application.

Task

A. Using a Block format, write a follow-up letter to ZCAS University regarding your internship (15 marks)

B. Identify and explain five advantages of written communication. (5 marks)

(Total 20 marks)

Question 4

A. Identify and explain five features of academic writing that are lacking in the essay written by John and explain how these features contribute to effective academic communication or writing. (10 marks)

B. Based on five points, differentiate between academic writing and general writing. (10marks)

Total 20 marks

Question 5

Write brief notes on the following

A. Persuasive essays (5 marks)

B. Argumentative essays (5 marks)

C. Descriptive essays (5 marks)

D. Narrative essays (5 marks)

Total 20 marks

End of examination